

FILM DOSSIER: FANTASTIC FOUR: SOLVE EVERYTHING

Phase 4 · Film #9 (Saga Two, Film #9 · Overall Film #38) · PHASE 4 FINALE

Status:  DOSSIER COMPLETE (awaiting showrunner lock)

1. IDENTITY

Field	Entry
Film #	Saga Two #9 (Phase 4, Film #9) · MCU #38
Phase	Phase 4 (finale), The Secret Wars Saga
Real title	<i>FANTASTIC FOUR: SOLVE EVERYTHING</i> (Hickman's opening arc)
Decoy / codename title	<i>"FAMILY DINNER"</i>
Release date	Friday, November 1, 2024
Distributor	Walt Disney Studios Motion Pictures
Director	Matt Shakman
Rating / runtime	PG-13 · 172 minutes
Genre + second genre	Superhero action-adventure + multiversal sci-fi / family tragedy

2. OWNERSHIP

Field	Entry
Whose film / franchise is this?	The Fantastic Four ensemble (Pedro Pascal leads), eleven years after <i>Fantastic Four</i> (2013)

Character	Actor	Age at release
Reed Richards / Mr. Fantastic (<i>plus the Council of Reeds</i>)	Pedro Pascal	49
Sue Storm / Invisible Woman	Vanessa Kirby	36
Johnny Storm / Human Torch	Joseph Quinn	31
Ben Grimm / The Thing	Ebon Moss-Bachrach	47
Victor von Doom	Robert Downey Jr.	59
Alicia Masters	Kerry Washington	47
Franklin Richards (<i>age 9</i>)	Fresh casting	–
Valeria Richards (<i>age 5, a genius</i>)	Fresh casting	–
Annihilus (<i>on-set performance capture</i>)	Fresh casting	–
Tony Stark / Doctor Strange (<i>the Illuminati</i>)	Marc-Anthony Bullock / Benedict Cumberbatch	42 / 48
Steve Rogers (<i>post-credit</i>)	Tyrese Avery	43

3. SOURCE MATERIAL (EARTH-616)

Field	Entry
Primary comic(s) adapted	Jonathan Hickman's <i>Fantastic Four</i> #570–572 (2009), "Solve Everything": Reed joins the Council of Reeds, Reed Richardses from across the multiverse who've sacrificed their families to "solve everything." He chooses his family* instead. <i>Fantastic Four</i> #583–588 (2010–11), "Three": Johnny Storm dies holding back Annihilus's army at the Negative Zone* portal.
Supporting comics	<i>FF</i> #1 (2011, the Future Foundation , and Doom joins it) · <i>FF</i> #579 (2010, Valeria asks Doom for help) · <i>Fantastic Four</i> #600 (2012, Johnny returns; held back) · Hickman's <i>Avengers</i> vol. 5 (2014, Cap remembers , the post-credit scene)
Nerf check	☒ Annihilus's horde is endless. Johnny holds the portal alone , and his nova flame fires for the first time before he's overwhelmed. He chooses to die.

3A. COMIC ACCURACY REPORT

Field	Entry
Overall accuracy score	96%. Hickman's "Solve Everything" and "Three" are adapted closely.

Straight from the page:

- **The Council of Reeds:** Reeds from other universes who **gave up their families** to solve every problem. **Reed joins them, then leaves** to go home (#570–572).
- **Valeria Richards**, a genius at age five, **secretly asks Doom for help** (#579). **Doom's intellect had been damaged**, and Valeria helps restore it.
- **"Three": Johnny Storm** holds the **Negative Zone portal** alone against **Annihilus** and his armies, and **dies** (#587).
- **The Fantastic Four becomes the Future Foundation**, and **Doom** joins it (*FF* #1, 2011).

Changes and why:

| Change | Why |

|---|---|

| The Council of Reeds is the **first on-screen look at other realities**, which **explains the Incursions** | It ties the film into the saga. Reed learns from other Reeds that **their universes are dying too**. |

| **Cap remembers** in the post-credit scene | It sets up **Phase 5, Time Runs Out**. On 616, Cap remembers the Illuminati's mind wipe in Hickman's *Avengers* (2014). |

POWERS & ABILITIES

Character	616 powers & abilities	Shown in this film	Held back (why)	Match
The Human Torch	Flame; flight; the nova flame	The nova flame, for the first time , as he holds the portal against thousands	—	✓ 100%
The Invisible Woman	Force fields , now at planet-holding scale	Holds up a collapsing portal from the other side	—	✓ 100%
Mr. Fantastic	Elasticity; genius	Out-argues the Council of Reeds	—	✓ 100%
The Thing	Class 85–100	Tears through the Annihilation Wave	—	✓ 100%
Annihilus	The Cosmic Control Rod ; commands the Annihilation Wave	Invades through the portal	—	✓ 100%
Doom	Genius; sorcerer; armor	Allies with the FF	—	✓ 100%

4. STORY

Field	Entry
Logline	Reed Richards meets a council of himself from a hundred other universes who've solved everything but love, just as the multiverse starts to die and one of the Fantastic Four stays behind so the others can live.
Theme	Family is the answer. Reed can't solve everything. He can only choose who to save.
Villain / antagonist	Annihilus (main); the Council of Reeds (Reed's temptation); Doom (who, for once, is an ally)

What the movie is about

ACT ONE: THE COUNCIL

- **Monday, June 3, 2024.** The Baxter Building. Reed, haunted by the Incursions, builds **a bridge into the multiverse.**
- He finds **the Council of Reeds: hundreds of Reed Richardses** from other Earths, who gave up their families to "solve everything."
- They show him **the truth: their universes are dying too. Every Earth is colliding with another one.**
- Reed stays with them for days, then **goes home** to Sue, Franklin and Valeria.

ACT TWO: VALERIA'S BARGAIN

- Five-year-old **Valeria**, a genius, **goes to Latveria alone** and **asks Doom for help:** *"Father can't solve this alone. Neither can you. Together, maybe."*
- **Doom joins the Future Foundation.** Reed and Doom work **side by side** for the first time.
- A breach **opens to the Negative Zone**, and **Annihilus** and his **Annihilation Wave** pour through.

ACT THREE: THREE

- The Baxter Building is under siege. The portal has to close from **the other side.**
 - **Johnny Storm** goes through. *"Go. I've got this."*
 - He **fires the nova flame** for the first time and holds off millions. **The portal closes.**
 - **Johnny is gone.**
 - The **funeral:** the FF, **Doom at the edge of the crowd**, Spider-Man in the back row. **The Fantastic Four becomes three.**
 - Reed looks up at the sky, where **three other Earths are now faintly visible.** Time is running out.
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5. MCU TIMELINE PLACEMENT

Field	Entry
When it's set	Monday, June 3, 2024 → Saturday, September 21, 2024. The post-credit scene is the next day .
Where it's set	The Baxter Building · Castle Doom, Latveria · the Council of Reeds' Bridge · the Negative Zone
Relative to other films	Two months after <i>Eternals</i>. The dead Celestial is still in the Pacific.

6. WORLD-BUILDING

The film's own world

- **Johnny is dead** (on 616 he comes back later).
- **The Future Foundation, Franklin and Valeria, and Doom as an ally.**

World-building for the wider MCU

Seed	How it appears	Payoff
The multiverse is real	The Council of Reeds	Saga Two
Doom inside the FF	Allied with Reed	<i>Time Runs Out</i>

Setting up the Big Bad (THE SECRET WARS SAGA)

Seed	How it appears	What it means
Every universe is dying	The Council's warning	The whole multiverse is failing
CAP REMEMBERS	The post-credit scene	<i>Time Runs Out</i> begins (Phase 5)

7. POST-CREDIT SCENES

Field	Entry
Mid-credit scene	✓ "THE CHAIR." At the Baxter Building's dinner table, one chair is empty . Ben sits down in it, and says nothing.
Post-credit scene	✓ "I REMEMBER." Avengers Mansion , at night. Steve Rogers jolts awake from a nightmare: Wakanda, the Black Swan, Tony's face , Strange's hands . The mind wipe is breaking . He sits up in the dark. CAP: "...I remember." CUT TO BLACK. TITLE CARD: "TIME RUNS OUT."
Secret shoot codenames	Mid-credit: " DINNER ." Post-credit: " WAKE-UP CALL ."

CHECKLIST

- [x] Comic(s) adapted · [x] Comic Accuracy Report + powers · [x] Real and decoy titles · [x] What it's about · [x] Villain · [x] Post-credit scenes · [x] The film's own world-building · [x] MCU world-building · [x] Big Bad setup · [x] Whose franchise · [x] When and where in the timeline